

CV IMPORTANT TOPICS:

Preamble:

“WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA, having solemnly resolved to constitute India into a SOVEREIGN SOCIALIST SECULAR DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC and to secure to all its citizens:

JUSTICE, social, economic and political;
LIBERTY of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship;
EQUALITY of status and of opportunity;
and to promote among them all
FRATERNITY assuring the dignity of the individual and the unity and integrity of the Nation;

IN OUR CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY this twenty-sixth day of November, 1949, do HEREBY ADOPT, ENACT AND GIVE TO OURSELVES THIS CONSTITUTION.”

Meaning and Importance of Constitution:

- The Constitution is the supreme law of the country.
- It provides the framework for government, defines powers and responsibilities, and protects citizens' rights.
- It ensures democracy, justice, and unity in a diverse nation.

Constitutional Assembly:

- The Constituent Assembly was formed in 1946 to draft the Constitution.
- It had 389 members (later 299 after Partition).
- The Constitution was adopted on 26 November 1949 and came into effect on 26 January 1950.

Features of Indian Constitution:

- Lengthiest written constitution.
- Federal system with a strong centre.
- Parliamentary form of government.
- Independent judiciary.

- Fundamental Rights and Duties.
- Directive Principles of State Policy.
- Secularism, Universal Adult Franchise, Single Citizenship.

Principles of State Policy (Directive Principles):

- Found in Part IV (Article 36 - 51).
- They are non-justiciable (not enforceable in court).
- Aim to establish social and economic democracy.
- Include principles like equal pay for equal work, promotion of education, health, and welfare of people.

Fundamental Rights (Article 12 - 35):

- Right to Equality (Art. 14–18).
- Right to Freedom (Art. 19–22).
- Right against Exploitation (Art. 23–24).
- Right to Freedom of Religion (Art. 25–28).
- Cultural and Educational Rights (Art. 29–30).
- Right to Constitutional Remedies (Art. 32).

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A):

- Added by the 42nd Amendment, 1976.
- 11 duties for citizens such as respecting the Constitution, protecting the environment, promoting harmony, safeguarding public property, etc.

Concept of Liberty:

- Liberty means freedom of thought, expression, belief, faith, and worship.
- Guaranteed in the Preamble and under Fundamental Rights (Art. 19–22).
- Liberty in India is not absolute; it is subject to reasonable restrictions to maintain public order, morality, and security.